

Exercises

5.1 Correct the mistakes in these idioms.

- 1 I don't have even a faint idea where he is today; you'll have to ask somebody else.
- 2 The title of the book has familiar rings to it, but I don't think I've ever read it.
- 3 My cousin knows the tax laws outside and in, so if you want advice on your tax, he'll help you.
- 4 I can't for life think what it was I came into the kitchen for.
- 5 I saw Tom and Lily together in a restaurant looking adoringly into each other's eyes.
I added up two and two, and decided they must be madly in love.

5.2 Use the corrected idioms from exercise 5.1 to rewrite the underlined parts of this paragraph. Use each idiom once only.

I always thought I knew my computer in every detail, but the other day it started to crash every time I opened a certain program. I could not in any way understand why it was doing this, and I didn't have any idea at all about what to do to fix it. I rang the helpline which I had used in the past, and after about 20 minutes I spoke to someone who said his name was Patrick, and that he was there to help me. He gave me some advice which sounded quite familiar to me from previous calls I had made to the same helpline. I thought about all this, put the facts together, and concluded that they give the same advice to everybody, and that it's just a way of getting rid of you. The computer still crashes every time I open the program.

5.3 Write sentences that mean the opposite of these sentences. Use idioms from this unit and make any other necessary changes.

- 1 Yes, that name is very familiar to me. I think I've met her several times.
- 2 I'm really up to date with TV soap operas these days. I watch them every day.
- 3 She knows absolutely nothing when it comes to the history of this area.
- 4 I correctly interpreted what she was trying to tell me and it solved a big problem.
- 5 No, sorry, her name means nothing to me. I may have met her, I just can't remember.

5.4 Complete each sentence with a different idiom which refers to 'not knowing'.

- 1 I how to use the photocopier. Do you think you could help me? (weakest of the three)
- 2 I where I left that letter I brought for you. I'm really sorry. (stronger than 1)
- 3 I what she's talking about. She's crazy! (even stronger than 2)

Over to you

Look up the word *know* in your dictionary or in an online dictionary and find idioms containing this word. Choose three idioms to learn, and make a note of them in your vocabulary notebook. Note down examples of how they are used, too.

A

Learning from experiences

If ...	you can say ...
something bad has happened, but you decide to learn from it instead of being upset by it,	I've decided to put it down to experience .
you don't know what your position is or what your situation is with someone, and it's worrying you,	I just want to know where I stand , that's all.
something happens or someone says something that makes you think very seriously about it,	the events / your suggestions have certainly given me food for thought .
something bad happens to you and you decide you will never let it happen again,	I've learnt my lesson .
someone does something stupid which affects them in a way that they'll never want to do it again,	that will teach him/her a lesson!
someone finally becomes aware of a fact (often used with unpleasant facts),	I think he/she's got the message .
you tell the true facts to someone who has believed a different set of facts up to that moment,	I just want to set/put the record straight .

B

Other common idioms connected with perceiving situations

I **heard it on/through the grapevine** that you're thinking of leaving the company. Is it true? [heard it from someone who had heard it from someone else]

He doesn't hate you at all. It's completely untrue. It's just **a figment of your imagination**. [something you have imagined which is not true]

The Prime Minister seems to have **lost sight of** why she was elected. She's broken all her promises to the people. [forgotten a central, important fact or truth about something]

What beats me is why people are prepared to sit in a traffic jam every morning for half an hour just to get to work. [what I cannot understand]

I'm **having second thoughts about** moving house. I like this part of the city and I'm not sure I'd be happy anywhere else. [I decided something, but now I am no longer sure about it]

I don't know all **the ins and outs of** the situation, but it seems that David has decided to move out of the flat he shares with Ruth and Monica. [the details of]

Language help

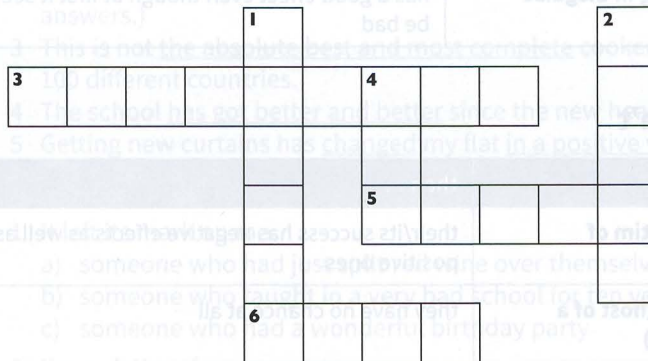
If an idiom has a preposition associated with it, e.g. *ins and outs of*, *second thoughts about*, always write the preposition with the idiom in your vocabulary notebook, as well as any other important structural information.

Exercises

6.1 In each of these conversations, the second speaker uses an idiom to repeat what the first speaker says. Complete the idioms.

- 1 Ben: Well, Luke has finally learnt that he can't expect everyone else to pay for him.
Philip: Yes, I think he's
- 2 Anne: Well, Sara will certainly learn never to do that again!
Ross: Yes, that should definitely
- 3 Frances: His suggestions are worth taking seriously, aren't they?
Brad: Yes, they've certainly given us
- 4 Will: Joe's convinced himself that his neighbours are drug smugglers. He's just crazy!
Nick: Yes, I'm sure the whole thing is a
- 5 Grace: Well, I think we were right to tell her what really happened, don't you?
Steve: Yes, it was important to

6.2 Complete the crossword.



Across

- 3 You can hear news through it.
- 5 She lost of the key points in the presentation.
- 6 Put it to experience.

Down

- 1 They're not your first thoughts.
- 2 Usually means *hits*, but is used in an idiom about not understanding something.
- 4 They go with 'outs'.

6.3 Complete each of these idioms.

- 1 I want to know I One day you say you love me, the next day you say I'm just a friend. It's driving me crazy.
- 2 He spent £500 of my money. I'll never lend him my credit card again. I've my
- 3 I don't know all the and of the situation, but I think one of the directors is going to resign. There must be a big problem.
- 4 I can understand that she needed help, but me is that she should ask someone as stupid as Leon to help her!

6.4 Answer these questions.

- 1 Think of an occasion when you learnt your lesson.
- 2 Think of something which happened to you that you decided to put down to experience.
- 3 Have you ever decided to do something, then had second thoughts about it? What was it?
- 4 Think of something you heard recently on the grapevine. What was it?
- 5 Have you ever been in a friendship or relationship where you had to say 'I need to know where I stand'? What was the situation?

